

Touched by tech

Check out some innovative initiatives for solving the potable water crisis affecting many nations worldwide

**Windows 9 is coming**

The successor to Windows 8 – codenamed 'Threshold' – will be unveiled on 30th September
<http://dgit.in/ThresholdWin9>

₹51.5 tr

A McKinsey report estimates that by 2025 close to 583 million people will constitute the Indian middle class. Their combined income is pegged at 51.5 trillion rupees! This represents tremendous potential to tap into for small business that target large audiences with moderate purchasing power

at its core but effective at targeting a very fundamental need of society. An idea can come from everywhere. Coming across a peculiar situation or attending a talk or demo might trigger an idea. The much publicised account of how Ratan Tata came up with the idea of the Nano when he saw a family of four struggling on a two-wheeler on a crowded Indian street isn't necessary a dreamy image.

An idea doesn't announce itself. So, the key to noticing its presence is to always be observant. The idea need not necessarily be a table toppling one. An improvement over an existing idea, addition of a game-changing feature, or increasing an idea's relevance to a specific target. All of these could be excellent startup strategies. A sterling example is the case of the Samwer brothers who've gained high visibility with their e-commerce focussed startup, Rocket Internet, by adopting the cloning strategy. Studies have shown that 'cloning' could lead to the fastest growing business. However, although copying a successful idea from another region, adapting it and selling it to the original proponents may have its benefits, it's without doubt a hindrance to genuine innovation. Keep your ear close to the ground. It will give you access to a galaxy of ideas, besides training you in execution, marketing and publicity strategies, among other things. Being in the thick of things always provides inspiration for cloning but it may also lead to a genuine Eureka moment.

Observing, reading and hoarding knowledge

Being observant entails continuously updating your knowledge about the latest

trends in technology and business. In this fast moving space, news get outdated and redundant very quickly, hence knowledge updation is critical. Fortunately, there are a variety of resources such as websites, forums, tech blogs, magazines and online newsletters that allow you to know about the latest startup business and trends.

- **Betalist.com** – Overview of upcoming internet startups. Early access to few featured startups.
- **Yourstory.in** – Extensive coverage of latest trends and happenings in the entrepreneurial space in India. Features upcoming startups and interviews with budding entrepreneurs.

840 mn

An estimated 70% of India lives under \$2 a day. A startup is yet to revolutionise this segment of close to 840 million people. Maybe your idea is the one.

neurs. Holds various meetups and conferences. Strong media platform for everything startup related.

- **alltopstartups.com** – Promising forum with great collection of articles and cover stories.
- **Wikindu.com** – Great interviews with young budding entrepreneurs.
- **Mashable and The Huffington Post** – Brilliant blogs pertaining to startup businesses.
- **NextBigWhat.com** – Another great resource in this category.



Apps provide information and means to stay connected

70%

A 2012 USA specific statistic indicates that 75% of all startups fail. A dismal 25% fail in their first year itself.

- **india.startuplogic.com** – Collates links from a variety of Indian web sources.
- **Wall Street Journal** – Exclusive sections dedicated to small businesses and startups.
- **WSJ Accelerators blog** – Fast gaining popularity.
- **Pluggd.in and VentureWoods** – Good India-specific resources.

Apps and tools

The internet is today accessed more often from handheld devices than personal computers so it's no surprise that the app revolution has gained so much momentum. Loads of apps and tools available online can cater to your needs as a budding entrepreneur – be it finding information, staying connected, pitching your idea or discussing it.

- **Zite and Flipboard** – Versatile news grabbers with excellent feed.
- **Nextgen reader** – Allows you to pin your favourite web sources such as Mashable, Wired, Lifehacker, etc. Updates feeds regularly.
- **Bloomberg and Business Insider** – Highly rated apps in the business news domain.
- **Tapatalk** – Gives you access a plethora of online forums from a single platform.
- **Meetup** – Locates meetings in your field of interest around you.
- **Wired PR Works** – Business tips, latest news and development and strategies.
- **PitchEngine** – Targeted at brand building.
- **Kickstarter** – Probably the most famous crowdfunding source.
- **Indiegogo and RocketHub** – These crowdfunding websites are not only fund raising tools, but also serve as a reservoir of ideas.